JAGANANNA VIDYA DEEVENA & VASATHI DEEVENA

Comprehensive Scheme Guidelines: Post-Matric Fee Reimbursement (RTF) and Maintenance / Boarding Support (MTF) Framework of Andhra Pradesh

1. Executive Summary & Scheme Architecture

To ensure quality higher education for economically weaker sections, the Government of Andhra Pradesh structured its post-matric welfare assistance into two flagship complementary components: Jagananna Vidya Deevena (RTF - Reimbursement of Tuition Fee) and Jagananna Vasathi Deevena (MTF - Maintenance of Tuition / Boarding Fee). These programs prevent dropouts from technical, vocational, undergraduate, and postgraduate programs by transferring financial grants directly to the student's mother via Aadhaar-linked Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT).

Jagananna Vidya Deevena (RTF)

The primary purpose of the Vidya Deevena scheme is to provide 100% reimbursement of full tuition fees, examination fees, and special fees fixed by regulatory bodies. These funds are disbursed in four quarterly tranches during each academic cycle directly into the mother's bank account. Eligible courses under this program include Polytechnic, ITI, B.Tech, M.Tech, MBBS, B.Pharmacy, MBA, MCA, B.Ed, Degrees, and Post-Graduation. The nodal department overseeing this scheme is the Department of Social Welfare, Government of Andhra Pradesh, and it is executed via the JnanaBhumi portal.

Jagananna Vasathi Deevena (MTF)

The Vasathi Deevena scheme provides financial support for food, boarding, hostel accommodations, and personal maintenance. Disbursement occurs in two equal semi-annual tranches per academic year directly into the mother's account. It covers students enrolled in ITI, Polytechnic, and Non-Professional or Professional Degree and PG programs. This initiative is managed by the Department of Social Welfare in coordination with the Backward Classes & Minority Welfare Departments.

2. Financial Entitlements and Slabs

The schemes operate under standardized annual benefit ceilings and fee benchmarks set by State Fee Regulatory Committees (APHERMC). The entitlements are categorized by educational stream.

ITI (Industrial Training Institutes): Under Vidya Deevena (RTF), students receive 100% of the approved tuition and special fees as per regulatory notification. Under Vasathi Deevena (MTF), they are entitled to 10,000 rupees per annum, which is disbursed in two tranches of 5,000 rupees each.

Polytechnic / Diploma Programs: The Vidya Deevena benefit covers 100% of the approved tuition and exam fees for regular diploma streams. The Vasathi Deevena benefit provides 15,000 rupees per annum, disbursed in two tranches of 7,500 rupees each.

Degree, Engineering & PG Programs: For courses such as B.A, B.Sc, B.Com, B.Tech, M.Tech, MBA, MCA, Pharmacy, and similar programs, Vidya Deevena provides full fee reimbursement covering all collegiate operational, tuition, and university fees. Vasathi Deevena offers 20,000 rupees per annum, distributed in two equal tranches of 10,000 rupees each.

3. Detailed Eligibility Parameters & Exclusion Criteria

To ensure precision targeting, candidates must satisfy rigorous socio-economic and demographic parameters:

- **Category & Social Inclusivity:** Students belonging to Scheduled Castes (SC), Scheduled Tribes (ST), Backward Classes (BC), Economically Backward Classes (EBC), Kapu, Minorities, and Differently Abled individuals are covered under standard income ceilings.
- **Income Ceiling:** Total household annual income must not exceed 2,50,000 (2.5 Lakhs) from all declared sources.
- **Mandatory Academic Attendance:** A verified biometric or facial attendance minimum of 75% per semester or quarter is required. Students falling short are ineligible for the corresponding release.
- **Agricultural Land Limits:** Family agricultural landholding must be below 10.00 acres of wet land or below 25.00 acres of dry land (or a combined equivalent not exceeding 25 acres).
- **Residential Property Limit:** In municipal or urban areas, the family's residential built-up area must not exceed 1,500 square feet.
- **Motor Vehicle Ownership:** Families owning a four-wheeler are strictly excluded, with explicit exceptions for tractors, autos, and taxis used strictly for daily livelihood.
- **Sanitation Workers Exemption:** Dependents of certified municipal sanitary workers are entitled to the schemes regardless of the household income ceiling.
- **Distance Education & Private Deemed Universities:** Students enrolled in distance mode, private correspondence courses, or deemed universities outside state counseling systems are generally excluded.
- **Public Employment & Taxation Exclusions:** Any family member drawing a regular government salary, a retired pension (excluding welfare pensions), or paying income tax disqualifies the student.

4. Disbursement Architecture & Mother-Centric DBT Mechanism

A key governance reform introduced in Andhra Pradesh shifted the fee remittance away from educational institutions straight into the student's mother's Aadhaar-seeded bank account. If the mother is deceased, the fund is released to the legally appointed natural guardian.

- **Parental Accountability:** By remitting tuition fees directly into mother accounts, mothers hold financial agency and directly pay colleges during quarterly parent-teacher meetings, ensuring institutional accountability.
- **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT):** All releases utilize the AP National Automated Clearing House (NACH) or PFMS payment gateways linked to the beneficiary's NPCI Aadhaar bank mapping.
- **Fee Reimbursement Card:** Every beneficiary is issued a verifiable digital/physical Fee Card tracking verified dues, sanction numbers, and college acknowledgement receipts.

5. Step-by-Step Application Workflow & Field Verification

- **Step 1: College Admission & Registration:** The student secures admission through state web-counseling (EAPCET, ICET, EDCET, POLYCET, etc.) or merit quotas. The college nodal scholarship officer uploads student credentials to the JnanaBhumi portal.
- **Step 2: Mother Bank & Biometric Linking:** The mother's Aadhaar, active NPCI-mapped savings bank account, ration card number, and caste/income certificates are integrated into the registration file.
- **Step 3: Field Verification (Grama/Ward Sachivalayam):** A Welfare and Education Assistant (WEA) or Ward Welfare & Development Secretary conducts door-to-door physical validation checking land, power meter, vehicle, and income status.
- **Step 4: Social Audit & Display of Lists:** Provisional eligible and ineligible lists are published on Sachivalayam notice boards for open social audit and objection filing.
- **Step 5: Sanction & Release of Tranches:** Final sanctioned lists are approved by District Welfare Officers (DWO). Quarterly or bi-annual releases are scheduled directly from the state treasury into beneficiary accounts.

6. Checklist of Mandatory Enclosures

Applicants must provide several key documents to complete their registration. Aadhaar cards of both the student and the mother or guardian are required. As proof of socioeconomic category, a BPL, White Ration Card, or Household Rice Card must be submitted. An Integrated Caste, Nativity, and Income certificate issued via MeeSeva is also mandatory. Financial details require a single bank passbook belonging to the mother, linked with Aadhaar and mapped in the NPCI or APB portal. Academically, the official convener quota or admission counseling seat allotment order is necessary. Finally, a JnanaBhumi integrated biometric attendance record is required to prove that the student maintains at least 75% attendance.